

BUILD. CODE. PLAY.

I'm starting a **FIRST® LEGO® League** team for kids in **K-3**, and the first step is finding out who wants in. They'll build LEGO machines, code them to actually do something, and figure out why they don't work the first time. **No experience needed** — for the kids or the grown-ups.

WHO

Clinton Public School families with kids in **K-3 (ages 5-9)**. No experience needed — just curiosity and a love of snapping bricks together. Parents are welcome to stick around at meetings; I'd rather have you there than not. One thing worth knowing before you sign up: **K-3 won't all be one team**. The note below explains why.

WHAT

FIRST LEGO League is a global youth robotics program that runs on LEGO Education kits. A small team of kids builds a model, programs it, fixes what doesn't work, and — if we get a team registered in time — takes it to a season-end celebration with other New Jersey teams. **Teamwork and problem-solving, dressed up as playing with LEGO**. That's the whole point.

WHEN

About an hour a week, starting this fall and running into late winter, aiming at a season-end event. The exact day, time, and meeting spot get set once I see who signs up — sign-ups first, calendar second.

COST

There is a real cost — FIRST charges **per team, not per child**, and it gets split across the roster. I'm not putting a number on it until I know which division we land in and how many kids are in, because those two things move it a lot. **Signing up costs nothing and commits you to nothing**; nobody owes a dollar until there's a real team and a real number I can show you. If cost is the thing standing in your way, tell me and we'll work it out.

ONE HONEST NOTE ABOUT GRADES

FIRST LEGO League splits its divisions by grade, and **no single one covers K-3**. So I'm gauging interest across the whole band first, then building whatever team — or teams — the sign-ups can actually support. Some grades may have to wait a year, mine included: I have a kindergartner and a third grader, and they probably won't end up on the same team. **Better you hear that from me now than in November**.

COACHES WANTED — yes, you

FIRST won't hand a team its roster until **two grown-ups** have cleared its background screening. I'm doing mine. Another parent has offered to be the second — nothing is locked in, and more names in the hat is better, so if you want that seat, tick the box on the sign-up form. **Zero robotics experience required**: I handle all the LEGO and all the code. What FIRST needs from you is your name on the team, a background check through them, about an hour a week, and one day at the season-end event. I need a second grown-up in the room, not a second engineer.



Scan to sign up in 30 seconds

Point your phone's camera at the code, or type in the address below. Signing up isn't a commitment — it just tells me your child's grade so I can work out what team is even possible. **It comes to me, not to the school**, and I'll delete it any time you ask. Questions? Email Jarad — a Clinton Public School dad (one in kindergarten, one in third grade) and the parent putting this together: jaradd@gmail.com

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